caused by overpopulation: the destruction of fish stocks by overfishing; the draining of lakes by over-extraction of groundwater for irrigation; deforestation; pollution of air, land, and sea; and species extinction. Hardin himself proposed a controversial solution to the problem of overpopulation, arguing that the government should deny welfare assistance to people who bred “excessively,” to prevent further births. Biologist Paul Ehrlich similarly advocated population control in *The Population Bomb*, with warnings that human numbers would soon reach a point where mass starvation would ensue.